



### And the winner is...

Dark Souls II walks away with the Golden Joystick award for GOTY. Find the full list at: <http://dgit.in/1rukxqD>



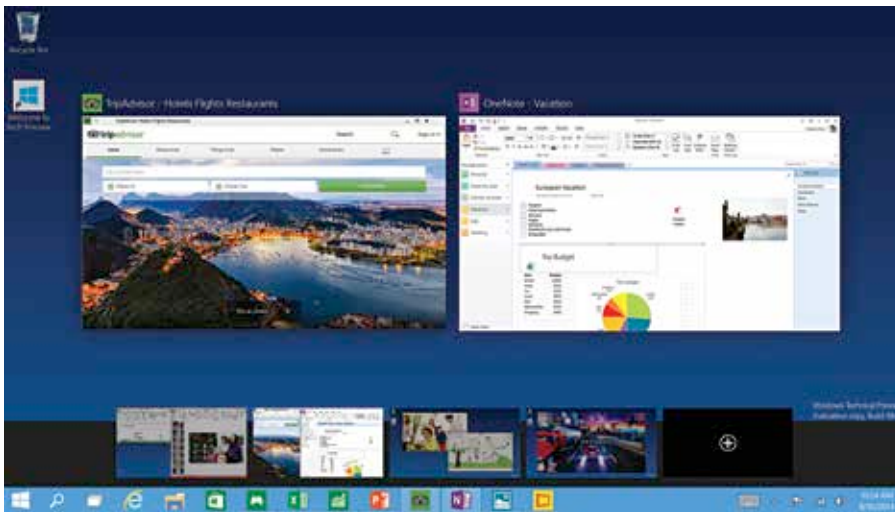
### Run by code

An interesting infographic on the rise and fall of the PC. Check it out at: <http://dgit.in/1tUFi6q>

and Modern mode thereby, easing the confusion among users.

### What we got

It's back! The venerable "Start" button is back at the corner where it belonged which when clicked (or touched) brings a shrivelled up Windows 7 like Start menu that succeeds in merging the Windows 8 Start Screen with Windows 7's Start menu.



The new app-switcher in Windows 10. More of the same but flashier presentation?

It includes traditional Windows 7 desktop elements to the left while live tiles sit at the right-side of the menu. Finally, the menu can be resized to accommodate the entire screen, although we would suggest otherwise. Another change for the better has been made by improving Modern UI and its elements and making them work well together with the classic design or format of the desktop. This has been achieved by making both UI's work well and co-exist together depending on whatever form of input the user is using, be it a mouse or a touchscreen. This only points to the fact that Modern UI is here to stay, at least according to Microsoft, but this time they've worked on it to make things less confusing and more intuitive.

## 2 Enough of Touch it Vs. Click it!

### What we wanted

Instead of getting a mixture of an OS suited for the mobile platform and PC, we wanted it to behave, look and work according to the platform that it's on and not force users

to use an interface that they're probably never going to be completely comfortable with. Why would you want your OS on the desktop to have touch based elements even when you don't have a touch screen? We're better off having multiple variants of the OS instead of having to do with the same OS for multiple devices like smartphones, tablets, hybrids, laptops and desktops. The best way to think of a work around for this

is by having multiple modes like touch and type within the OS itself. Thereby showing pure PC users that Microsoft isn't taking them for granted.

### What we got

Touch based UI elements do stay on as we are now seeing a variety of touch-enabled PCs that can take advantage of the UI. But it seems like Microsoft has finally grasped the boundary between touch and click. We say this because according to the tweaks that we've seen in Windows 10, Microsoft has addressed the issues that PC users had with Windows 8, where users were forced into using a desktop designed for mobile devices, by adding buttons for important actions such as task-switching, among others. Although touch still plays a big part in Windows 10, it doesn't hamper the functionality of regular or classic desktop apps. Not only that, touch based devices get the modern UI based Start Menu and apps by default, while Desktops or laptops without touch based interface options get the classic UI out-

of-the-box. We hope Microsoft continues down this road because this is what we've asked for time and time again.

## 3 Gestures for a change please. Thank you!

### What we wanted

The good old married couple that is the keyboard and mouse are still lovely for interacting with a PC and despite this fact, it wouldn't hurt to try and innovate a bit by adding gesture support within the OS. Considering Microsoft already has a good enough foundation in the form of the Kinect for the Xbox. Gesture support would be the real ticket to the future.

### What we got

Although more touch gestures have been added, not much has been said about getting Kinect like functionality for the PC. If Windows has to become an OS for everything digital, Microsoft will have to think of other ways of interacting with the PC and here is where Kinect can help for sure. According to recent reports, Microsoft released a Kinect adapter for Windows 8 and 8.1 for \$49 (or ₹3,200) which allows the Kinect's sensors to work with Windows by making use of USB 3.0. This news is genuinely exciting and we hope to see the final build of Windows 10 have it.

## 4 Merger of PC settings and Control Panel

### What we wanted

The existence of the desktop style Control Panel and Modern-style PC settings differently within the same OS made it difficult to search for a particular setting. In many cases, users were left scratching their heads about which menu between the two would have the particular setting that they wished to change. This made it extremely frustrating when users wanted to change a setting and they were left searching for it between two different settings menus.

### What we got

It's sad to know that Microsoft still hasn't fixed the annoying existence of two separate settings menus for a single device. You'll still find "PC Settings" and "Control Panel" separate in the Start menu which make it difficult to hunt down a setting.